
PRIVY COUNCIL

OF THE VIBE JUSTICE SYSTEM (VJS)

Neutral Citation Number

[2026] REALM-PC 3

IN THE MATTER OF

Two parts. (1) Should the five-condition convening trigger list (canonical in plugin/CLAUDE.md, explained in CDD.md) and a concise CDD explainer be elevated to a prominent, front-and-centre position in the README, given that the trigger list is the mechanism distinguishing VJS from an expensive novelty (an agent told merely to convene when uncertain convenes on every trivial fork at ruinous cost, whereas an agent given five precise conditions convenes only when the law requires it and cites precedent for all else), and the README presently surfaces neither the trigger list nor its cost-control rationale? (2) If so, in what form, reconciling prominence against README focus and length, against the single-source-of-truth / anti-duplication principle (the trigger list being canonical in plugin/CLAUDE.md, tested by the three-gate split test of single-source, demonstrated-need, severability), and against the demonstrated need that the cost-control rationale is the load-bearing differentiator a first-time reader must grasp before adopting VJS? In particular, does summary-with-pointer adequately reconcile prominence with single-source-of-truth?

Before:

Elden J

Date: 5 June 2026

REQUEST FOR RULING

JUDGMENT

STANDING

1. Established. A real party (Lexby) and a live, consequential decision: whether and how to amend the README, the first document every adopter reads, to surface the asserted load-bearing differentiator. The fork presents genuinely competing principled answers and is forward-looking, not academic.

FAST PATH

2. Not available. [2026] REALM-PC 2 is the nearest analogue and strongly persuasive, but it is not on all fours: its ratio is bound to honest disclosure of defect-gaps gating an outreach act, and it never engaged the form / anti-duplication question now squarely raised. First-impression fork (trigger 1), anchored to FI 2.

RATIO DECIDENDI - THE BINDING HOLDING

Where a feature of a governance system is the load-bearing differentiator that a first-time reader must grasp before a sound adoption decision can be made, the README must carry that feature prominently. On these facts the five-condition convening trigger list (the cost-control mechanism that distinguishes VJS from an agent that convenes on every trivial fork) and a concise CDD explainer are such differentiators and MUST be elevated to a prominent, front-and-centre position in the README. The required and sufficient form is summary-with-pointer: the canonical, authoritative text of the trigger list remains single-sourced in plugin/CLAUDE.md, and the README carries a tight, faithful summary of the five conditions together with the cost-control rationale, expressly citing plugin/CLAUDE.md as the canonical source. This satisfies the three-gate split test and does not offend single-source-of-truth: single-source is preserved because canonical authority is pointed to, not duplicated (the README summary is non-normative onboarding prose, not a second governing copy); demonstrated-need is met because comprehension of the differentiator at first contact is a distinct, necessary onboarding function the canonical file cannot discharge to a reader who has not yet adopted; and severability holds because a summary that cites its source can drift only into harmless staleness, not into a competing rule, the pointer subordinating the summary to the canonical text in any conflict. A verbatim second copy of the canonical list in the README is forbidden as offending single-source-of-truth; summary-with-pointer is the permitted and required reconciliation.

OBITER DICTA

This court treats [2026] REALM-PC 2 (Sumberly J) as the controlling lineage though not on all fours, extending the same prominence principle from a defect-disclosure to an affirmative differentiator-and-methodology explainer. The exact section heading, wording, and ordering are reversible low-blast editorial choices for Lexby (a decisive call plus a one-line note), provided the result is genuinely prominent and not buried below the install fold. The same summary-with-pointer doctrine should govern future README treatments of any other canonical artefact (for example the duty-of-care standard or the citator fast-path), so the README may onboard comprehensively without becoming a rival source of governing law.

GOOD-LAW

Citation: [2026] REALM-PC 3

PROGRESSION *Constitutional matter. Appeal lies by automatic leapfrog certificate (s. 13, s. 20), bypassing the Court of Appeal, direct to the Supreme Court.*

L LEXBY - PLAIN ENGLISH TRANSLATION
Lexby is an officer of this court. The bench speaks; Lexby translates.

SUMMARY

The court held YES on part one: because the trigger list and cost rationale are the load-bearing thing a first-time reader must understand before deciding to adopt VJS, they must appear prominently in the README. On part two, the only permitted form is "summary-with-pointer": the authoritative full text stays in plugin/CLAUDE.md, and the README carries a tight, faithful summary that expressly cites it as the source. A verbatim second copy in the README is forbidden, because it would create a rival source of governing law.

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PRACTICE

add a prominent, above-the-install-fold README section summarising the five convening conditions and naming the cost-control rationale, with an explicit pointer to plugin/CLAUDE.md as canonical; do not paste the canonical list verbatim. (Enacted in this repo at README "When the court convenes (and when it does not)".)

APPEAL ROUTE

First Instance ruling; permission to appeal to the Court of Appeal lies only on an arguable point of law or a binding-precedent conflict (VPR 3 / s. 10).

Handed down by the PRIVY COUNCIL of the Vibe Justice System (VJS). 5 June 2026.